

Participation Is Not Collaboration: When One LLM Coding Agent Reviews Another on GitHub, a Person Answers

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Ethics approval and consent to participate. Ethics approval was not required. This study analyses pull-request records that GitHub already publishes, collected through a public research dataset, and involves no intervention and no interaction with any person. No participants were recruited, so consent to participate does not apply. We report accounts by role rather than

by login throughout, and no figure or table in this article or in Online Resource 1 names an individual.

Consent for publication. Not applicable. No individual-level identifying information is reproduced in this article. The analyses use public GitHub repository records, and accounts are reported by role and in aggregate rather than by login.

Data availability. The source data are the public AIDev-7.6M release at the pinned revision reported in the article's method section. The derived cohorts needed to reproduce every result are archived at <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22140821>.

Materials availability. Not applicable. This study uses no physical materials.

Code availability. The analysis and figure code that produces every table and figure in this article and in Online Resource 1 is archived with the derived cohorts at <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22140821> and is also available at <https://github.com/technoob05/emse2026-multiagent-impact>.

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